

Standard Chartered

Feedback from Hong Kong; Constructive on delivery in a compounding growth phase

We remain constructive on StanChart's ability to deliver sustainable ROTE growth to 15.5% 28E JPMe with expansion to c18% 2030E thereafter, following our Day 1 participation in several sessions on StanChart's divisions, and the operations & technologies that underpin them. We believe StanChart's ROTE targets (>15% 2028E) are relatively conservative in the current economic environment considering the Group's growth momentum. The Group is now in its "compounding growth phase" where we see potential for further market share gains supported by continued investments, EPS growth (JPMe 19% CAGR 25-28E) with greater non-NII gearing going forward (JPMe 51% of 28E Group income vs 47% FY25), and a more dynamic approach to capital management within the 13-14% CET1 target range focused on distributions (including a ≥30% div payout) with investment optionality. With the seminars in Hong Kong still ongoing, we leave our forecasts unchanged but under review.

- Conservative medium-term targets amid current growth momentum and favorable economic environment:** As discussed in our first take [here](#), STAN has outlined its medium-term financial framework with targets to 2028 which were broadly in line with expectations although conservative, in our view. 1) RoTE of >15% by 2028 (vs 11.9% FY25 and JPMe 15.5% 28E), building to ~18% by 2030, which we believe is realistic; 2) high-teens 25-28E EPS CAGR (vs JPMe c18%) and a 5-7% income CAGR (vs JPMe 5.6%); 3) cost-to-income ratio of ~57% by 2028 from 63% in 2025 (vs JPMe c56% 28E), supported by positive income-to-cost jaws each year; 4) CET1 ratio operating range of 13-14% although with intention to operate at the mid-point on average; 5) dividend payout ratio of ≥30% with progressive DPS (vs JPMe 35%).
- Business mix to drive +380bps ROTE uplift:** The Group's focus on Affluent (within Wealth & Retail) and Cross-border/Financial Institutions (within CIB) offers more attractive income/RWA metrics than other customer segments. Based on disclosed data, we calculate that PB (AUM>US\$10mil) and priority private (\$1mil<AUM<\$10mil) income per client is 218x/44x times higher than premium (\$25k<AUM<\$100k). And FI business RoRWA is 190bps higher than that of corporate in 2025. These segments are also faster-growing with stronger operating leverage. Within this, asset/liability optimisation of surplus liquidity is targeted to drive +50bps ROTE and support NIM. While STAN's deposit franchise has traditionally been weaker compared to peers, we see undiscounted value in growth trends as the business focuses on quality deposits.
- 3rd largest Wealth Manager in Asia, within that, PB AUM ranks #5 in Asia:** STAN's net new money and AUM growth has outpaced peers in recent years, leading it to become the 3rd largest WM in Asia (vs 5th in 2020) with \$422bn AUM. The Group is focused on quality client acquisition, particularly International and HNW clients, and on internal up-tiering which offers a

Overweight

STAN.L, STAN LN

Price (20 May 26):1,928p

Price Target (Dec-27):2220.0p

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Quarterly Forecasts (FYE Dec)

Adj. EPS (\$)	2025A	2026E	2027E
Q1	0.50	0.64A	
Q2	0.65	0.59	
Q3	0.41	0.50	
Q4	0.25	0.41	
FY	2.34	2.30	2.84

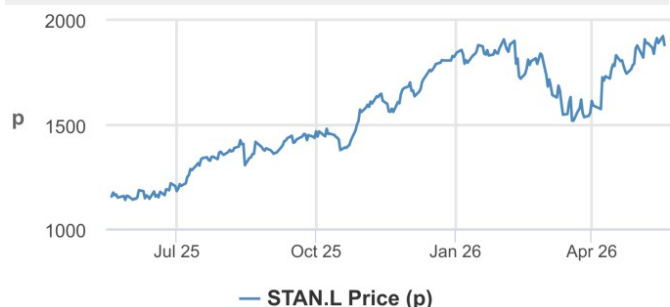
Style Exposure

Quant Factors	Current %Rank	Hist %Rank (1=Top)			
		6M	1Y	3Y	5Y
Value	40	20	22	11	48
Growth	56	71	40		
Momentum	5	60	12	45	83
Quality		88	89	73	67
Low Vol	74	93	73	70	98
ESGQ	86	65	65	93	65

Sources for: Style Exposure – J.P. Morgan Global Markets Strategy; all other tables are company data and J.P. Morgan estimates.

See page 7 for analyst certification and important disclosures, including non-US analyst disclosures.

Price Performance



	YTD	1m	3m	12m
Abs	3.1%	2.7%	5.3%	62.5%

Company Data

Shares O/S (mn)	2,330
52-week range (p)	1,938-1,113
Market cap (\$ mn)	60,153.68
Exchange rate	74.66
Free float (%)	100%
3M ADV (mn)	5.78
3M ADV (\$ mn)	132.2
Volatility (90 Day)	39
Index	-
BBG ANR (Buy Hold Sell)	15 5 2

Key Metrics (FYE Dec)

\$ in millions	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Financial Estimates				
Net interest income	11,184	11,372	11,600	12,079
Non interest income	9,645	10,671	11,529	12,391
Operating expenses	(13,145)	(13,232)	(12,947)	(13,585)
Adj. PPOP	7,684	8,810	10,183	10,885
Provision for loan losses	(672)	(1,059)	(1,023)	(1,134)
Adj. PBT	7,009	7,736	9,160	9,751
Adj. net income	5,629	5,097	6,044	6,463
Adj. EPS	2.34	2.30	2.84	3.18
BBG EPS	2.22	2.32	2.79	3.22
DPS	0.61	0.80	0.99	1.11
Loans	286,788	298,403	310,708	323,546
Deposits	530,161	559,924	593,176	620,633
Total Assets	919,955	957,543	997,261	1,038,702
Margins and Growth				
NIM	2%	2%	2%	2%
Ratios				
Loan/ Deposit ratio	54%	53%	52%	52%
NPL / Loans	2%	2%	2%	2%
Coverage	52%	52%	52%	52%
CET 1	14.1%	13.6%	13.7%	13.8%
Non-int. income/ Income	46%	48%	50%	51%
Cost/Income	63%	60%	56%	56%
LLP/Loans	(0.2%)	(0.4%)	(0.3%)	(0.4%)
ROA	0.6%	0.5%	0.6%	0.6%
ROE	12.4%	10.9%	12.6%	12.9%
Valuation				
Dividend yield	2.4%	3.1%	3.8%	4.3%
Adj. P/E	11.0	11.2	9.1	8.1
P/ BV	1.2	1.2	1.1	1.0

Summary Investment Thesis and Valuation

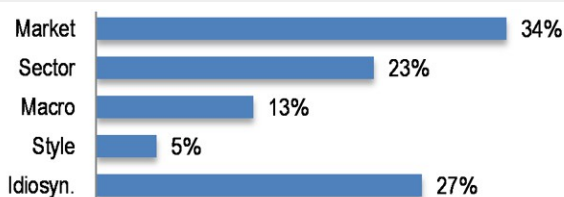
Investment Thesis

We view StanChart as undervalued relative to sector/EM peers at 1.2x PTNAV 27E with significant earnings growth potential supported by structural growth drivers and relatively high capital return. With the Group's 24-26E targets already achieved by FY25 across revenues and distributions, we now forecast c5.5% revenue growth CAGR across '25-28E driven by non-NII in 26, and broadening out to both NII/non-NII in outer years. We see this led by Wealth (driven by Affluent segment opportunities), Financial Markets (alongside cross-border income) and Banking. We expect FY26E NII +2% y/y due to lower rates and pass-throughs offset by volume growth. We expect cost growth at a c1% CAGR 25-28E as we expect growing investments in the future to capitalise on productivity and revenue opportunities, with positive operating leverage expected annually and the CIR to decline towards mid-50s. Overall, we expect stated ROTE to grow to c15.5% 28E, alongside a 35% dividend payout ratio and \$2-2.5bn/y buybacks, offering a total yield of 7-9%/y.

Valuation

We value StanChart using a SOTP methodology with divisional multiples differentiated by type of business. We value Corporate, Commercial and Institutional Banking at 8.5x P/E, and Consumer, Private & Business Banking Commercial at 10.0x P/E. We value excess capital above 13.0% at 1x. Our Dec-27 PT is 2,220p.

Performance Drivers



Factors	6M Corr	1Y Corr
Market: MSCI UK	0.77	0.63
Sect: Financials	0.59	0.65
Ind: Banks	0.74	0.72
Macro:		
US Breakeven 10 Year	0.50	0.39
JPM USD Tradeable Currency	0.31	0.32
JPM JULI Portfolio Spread Treasury	-0.26	-0.16
Quant Styles:		
Quality	-0.55	-0.46
DivYld	-0.47	-0.44
LowVol	-0.39	-0.33

significant source of AUM growth. International clients (c400k clients) with accounts in >3 markets typically have c3x more AUM than single-market clients. Priority Private (within HNW, AUM >\$1mil) offers the highest returns with c75% of clients up-tiered internally which drives 3x AUM post-up-tiering (vs pre-up-tiering), from 2023 client base +1.7x and NNM +10x. The Group is also the 5th largest PB in Asia (up from #8th in 2023) with the UHNW client base growing by +80% in the last 2Y and clients NNM up 2 times. There are also strong cross-sell economics between divisions: 1) PB clients with CIB relationships generate 4x AUM than standard PB clients; 2) Affluent clients with SME relationships hold 5x more AUM compared to standard Affluent clients. Relationship managers have grown +18% over the last 2Y with a third coming from internal referrals, alongside a +40% growth in senior RMs. The Group remains focused on further pivoting towards Affluent clients, away from mass-market, single-product relationships.

- **Originate to Distribute (O2D) focus in the CIB:** Financial Institution income/RWA was 8.0% FY25 compared to 6.1% for Corporates, both of which have grown from 7.2%/4.4% respectively in FY19. Growth in origination volume is targeted at +10% CAGR while growth in distribution volume is targeted at mid-teens% CAGR, which leverages on the Group's network to support higher Fee & capital-light income, and deeper client penetration. We note that most of the Group's distribution is with Banks, compared to our previous expectations of NBFIs, which offers more sustainability in our view. Whilst there is limited appetite to enter into Equities, we note that FICC revenues are more capital-light given the focus on flow income. Overall CIB income is expected to support the Group's 5-7% income CAGR across 25-28E, alongside further improvements in income/RWA.
- **AI to drive greater productivity:** The Group's Unified Enterprise Platform across 54 markets offers standardisation and greater connectivity across platforms which allows for greater productivity, more-informed risk management, and better data maneuverability (with 150 data lakes now consolidated into a single global data supply chain). The Group targets a +20% improvement in employee productivity by 28E, partly supported by >15% reduction in Corporate functions headcount by 30E - which will drive the CIR towards 57% 28E.
- **Systems are future-proof:** In 4Q, the Group migrated to a global private cloud which offers 10x processing power and greater resilience to disturbances (e.g. outages, geopolitical tensions). The Group also completed its HK mainframe migration in March to a global core banking platform, with >90% of markets now on a single platform (and Korea/Taiwan to move soon), offering greater agility for code deployment. The source code is also proprietary, removing reliance on third parties.
- **RMB internationalization will become an increasingly important driver of Markets income.** Policy support is aimed at expanding product availability and growing the stock of CNH assets held outside mainland China. The next major catalyst could be the rollout of dual-quoting for H-share companies listed in HK (which is already approved). This could materially increase liquidity in RMB-denominated equity products offshore through the Connect programme, and reinforce RMB internationalisation following the recent surge in Dim Sum bond issuance.
- **Operate at the mid-point of the 13-14% target CET1 range, on average.** With increased capital generation expected across the plan (JPMe c210bps/y CET1 average from profits), capital use will be broadly split across dividends (≥30% div payout targeted), RWA growth, and other capital uses with a hierarchy of buybacks, additional RWA growth opportunities to drive a higher trajectory of income growth, and inorganic opportunities. The Group is more confident in generating returns from RWA deployment, especially as Global Banking sub-optimal RWAs have declined c70% since 2019.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

Standard Chartered (Overweight; Price Target: 2220.0p)

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StanChart SOP

£m								
£ MILLION Division	Post Tax Profit 2028E	Allocated B4 Equity 2028E	RWAs £ bn 2028E	Valuation Basis	£ mn Value	£ Per Share	(x) PE	(x) P/BV
Corporate, Commercial & Institutional Banking	3,777	21,314	164.0	P/E	32,108	15.99	8.5	
Consumer, Private and Business Banking	2,408	6,254	48.1	P/E	24,085	11.99	10.0	
Corporate centre and other	-1,016	2,680	20.6	P/E	-9,141	-4.55	9.0	
Capital Excess		1,959		1 times BV	1,959	0.98		1.0
Standard Chartered Group	5,170	32,207	232.7		49,011	24.4	9.5	
Standard Chartered Group (Dec-2027)						22.2		

J.P. Morgan estimates.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

- **Macro-economic risks:** Being an EM-focused bank, StanChart is exposed to general macro-economic risk in EM such as slowdowns, inflationary pressures, depreciation of EM currencies and cross-border and political risks. COVID-19 continues to be a risk towards revenues and impairments in the near term, particularly in Asian economies, as well as geopolitical tensions creating a potential headwind.
- **Provisioning outlook:** We expect provisions at normalised levels across the medium term given growing pressures in the economic environment. An increase or decrease in provisions as a result of the economic outlook or with regards to specific cases poses a risk to our forecasts.

- **Regulatory uncertainty:** Standard Chartered remains exposed to changes in the regulatory environment in the UK, with capital requirements being set by the PRA in the UK. While StanChart has limited UK exposure, the Group is still subject to regulatory changes such as Basel 4 and BoE stress tests.

Standard Chartered: Summary of Financials

Income Statement							Balance Sheet						
	FY24A	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	FY29E		FY24A	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	FY29E
Interest income	11,112	11,184	11,372	11,600	12,079	-	Cash and cash equivalents	48,168	48,168	48,168	48,168	48,168	-
Interest expense	-	-	-	-	-	-	Deposits with banks	58,872	58,872	58,872	58,872	58,872	-
Net interest income	11,112	11,184	11,372	11,600	12,079	-	Net loans	281,032	286,788	298,403	310,708	323,546	-
Non interest income	8,308	9,645	10,671	11,529	12,391	-	PP&E	2,425	2,425	2,425	2,425	2,425	-
o/w Fee income	3,734	4,249	4,701	5,079	5,459	-	Net intangibles	5,791	6,231	6,418	6,610	6,809	-
o/w Trading income	9,443	10,294	11,389	12,305	13,225	-	Financial Assets Available for Sale	-	-	-	-	-	-
Net revenues	19,420	20,829	22,043	23,129	24,471	-	Other assets	453,400	517,471	543,257	570,477	598,883	-
Non interest expense	(12,402)	(13,145)	(13,232)	(12,947)	(13,585)	-	Total assets	849,688	919,955	957,543	997,261	1,038,702	-
o/w Employee costs	(8,510)	(9,109)	(9,170)	(8,972)	(9,414)	-	Interest earning assets	397,270	403,502	415,352	427,899	440,986	-
Pre-Prov. Profits	7,018	7,684	8,810	10,183	10,885	-	Deposits	464,489	530,161	559,924	593,176	620,633	-
Provisions	(1,135)	(737)	(1,084)	(1,033)	(1,144)	-	Borrowings	66,359	67,907	67,730	67,550	67,366	-
Adj. PBT	5,991	7,009	7,736	9,160	9,751	-	Other liabilities	274,058	274,829	282,190	287,012	299,308	-
Income taxes	(1,972)	(1,866)	(2,020)	(2,473)	(2,633)	-	Total liabilities	804,906	872,897	909,844	947,738	987,307	-
Minority interest	8	(12)	(13)	(13)	(13)	-	Shareholder equity	44,388	46,593	47,234	49,058	50,930	-
Adj. Net profit	4,315	5,629	5,097	6,044	6,463	-	Minority interests	394	465	465	465	465	-
PPOP per share	2.76	3.29	4.01	4.84	5.42	-	Total liabilities and Shareholder equity	849,688	919,955	957,543	997,261	1,038,702	-
Reported EPS	1.38	1.90	2.30	2.84	3.18	-	Interest bearing liabilities	-	-	-	-	-	-
Adj. EPS	1.65	2.34	2.30	2.84	3.18	-	Book Value Per Share	18.43	20.74	21.99	23.84	26.00	-
DPS	0.37	0.61	0.80	0.99	1.11	-	Tangible Book Value Per Share	14.99	16.77	18.13	19.65	21.53	-
Diluted shares outstanding	2,610	2,404	2,219	2,129	2,030	-							
Balance Sheet Gearing							Asset Quality/Capital						
	FY24A	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	FY29E		FY24A	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	FY29E
Loans/Deposits	61%	54%	53%	52%	52%	-	Loan loss reserves/Loans	(1%)	(1%)	(1%)	(1%)	(1%)	-
Investment/Assets	46%	49%	51%	52%	53%	53%	NPLs/Loans	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	-
Loan/Assets	35%	33%	32%	32%	32%	-	Loan loss reserves/NPLs	62%	58%	52%	52%	52%	52%
Customer deposits/Liabilities	58%	61%	62%	63%	63%	-	NPL y/y growth	(14%)	(4%)	1%	2%	2%	-
LT debt/Liabilities	8%	8%	8%	7%	7%	7%	Tier 1 ratio	17%	17%	16%	16%	16%	-
							CET1 ratio	14.2%	14.1%	13.6%	13.7%	13.8%	-
							CET1 capital	35,188	36,438	36,729	38,478	40,258	-
Ratio Analysis (%)							Ratio Analysis (%)						
	FY24A	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	FY29E		FY24A	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E	FY29E
Net interest margin	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	-	Return on equity (ROE)	9.7%	12.4%	10.9%	12.6%	12.9%	-
Non interest income/Net revenue	43%	46%	48%	50%	51%	-	Return on assets (ROA)	0.5%	0.6%	0.5%	0.6%	0.6%	-
Non interest income/Avg. Assets	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	-	ROTE	11.7%	14.7%	13.0%	15.1%	15.5%	-
Efficiency ratio	64%	63%	60%	56%	56%	-	Tax rate	33%	27%	26%	27%	27%	-
Leverage ratio	4.8%	4.9%	4.9%	4.9%	4.9%	-	Net loans y/y growth	(2%)	2%	4%	4%	4%	-
Revenue/Assets	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	-	Assets y/y growth	3%	8%	4%	4%	4%	-
RORWA	1.8%	2.2%	1.9%	2.2%	2.3%	-	RWA y/y growth	1%	4%	5%	4%	4%	-
RWA	247,065	258,031	269,663	280,139	290,841	-	Deposits y/y growth	(1%)	14%	6%	6%	5%	-
Avg. RWA	245,608	252,548	263,847	274,901	285,490	145,420	Net interest income y/y growth	8%	1%	2%	2%	4%	-
LLR	(3,948)	(3,087)	(3,118)	(3,180)	(3,244)	-	Revenues y/y growth	9%	7%	6%	5%	6%	-
NPLs	6,203	5,964	6,024	6,144	6,267	-	Adj. EPS y/y growth	37%	42%	(2%)	24%	12%	-
P/BV (x)	1.4	1.2	1.2	1.1	1.0	-	BVPS y/y growth	9%	12%	6%	8%	9%	-
P/TBV (x)	1.7	1.5	1.4	1.3	1.2	-	IE assets/Assets	64%	62%	61%	61%	61%	-
Adj. P/E (x)	15.6	11.0	11.2	9.1	8.1	-	Margins (as % of Avg. Assets)	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	-
Dividend yield	1.4%	2.4%	3.1%	3.8%	4.3%	-	LLP/Loans	(0.2%)	(0.2%)	(0.4%)	(0.3%)	(0.4%)	-
Dividend payout	26.9%	32.3%	35.0%	35.0%	35.0%	-	Equity/Assets	5.3%	5.1%	5.0%	4.9%	4.9%	-
							Cost/Assets	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	-
							Assets/Equity	18.8	19.5	20.0	20.3	20.4	20.4

Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.
Note: \$ in millions (except per-share data). Fiscal year ends Dec

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Standard Chartered (STAN.L, STAN LN) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Jun 27, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price (p)	Price Target (p)
01-Aug-23	OW	747	980
07-Sep-23	OW	702	990
16-Jan-24	OW	605	820
26-Feb-24	OW	635	850
10-Apr-24	OW	673	900
03-May-24	OW	756	1,000
31-Jul-24	OW	770	1,020
04-Dec-24	OW	966	1,180
24-Feb-25	OW	1183	1,390
04-Aug-25	OW	1355	1,490
09-Sep-25	OW	1391	1,670
17-Oct-25	OW	1428	1,690
03-Nov-25	OW	1560	1,770
02-Dec-25	OW	1681	1,880
05-Feb-26	OW	1857	2,170
25-Feb-26	OW	1789	2,200
06-May-26	OW	1819	2,220

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IB clients**	83%	79%	74%
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IB clients**	94%	93%	85%

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